



emerge, or possibly longer. So far, it is a hypothetical kind of intelligence where a machine learns and starts ‘thinking’ and working like a human being.

OpenAI, of which Elon Musk was a part earlier, is a pioneer in this field. Elon Musk and Sam Altman established OpenAI in December 2015 in San Francisco. At present, Sam Altman is heading it. Its stated goal is to ensure AGI benefits all of humanity. They have to their credit the GPT series, including GPT-4 and GPT-4.5.

Google/Alphabet is working on the DeepMind AGI model with neuroscience-inspired architectures and scalable learning. Their projects include AlphaGo, AlphaZero, AlphaFold, and the AGI-capable model Gemini.

xAI, founded by Elon Musk in March 2023, has as its mission to “Understand the true nature of the universe.” It has Grok chatbot as its initial project with the long-term focus on AGI.

Meta (Facebook), led by Mark Zuckerberg as CEO, aims to build an ‘open-source AGI.’ Their AI projects include LLaMA models, multi-modal AI, and AI assistants.

Microsoft, in partnership with

OpenAI, is focusing on the integration of AGI into their products like Windows, Office, and GitHub CoPilot. They are working on AI scaling, safety, and infrastructure.

Besides such companies from the USA, Mistral AI from France is working on open-weight LLMs (large language models), possibly aiming towards AGI. In China, Huawei, Baidu, Tencent, and Alibaba are also doing some AGI research. There are also several academic institutions, such as Stanford AI Lab, UC Berkeley, MIT CSAIL, Oxford, and Cambridge, conducting foundational research on AGI and AI alignment. Of course, IBM Research is also active in this field.

In India, the emerging players working on AGI-related research include IIT Madras, IISc Bangalore, and some other IITs in Delhi, Mumbai, Kanpur, and Hyderabad. In the private sector, TCS and Infosys are laying the groundwork for infrastructure and models that may enable broader AGI research.

Some startups in India also claim to be working on strong AI or AGI-like systems. Noteworthy among

these are Sarvam AI, backed by OpenAI’s ex-researchers, Krutrim by Ola founder Bhavish Aggarwal, and VigyanLabs, which is exploring some AGI-enabling tools.

The harsh truth is that India is not yet at the forefront of AGI research, although the Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) has launched programmes like the ‘National AI Portal’ and the ‘IndiaAI Mission’ to help scale AI research and innovation. DRDO (Defence R&D Organisation) and ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) are acting on their own plans for AGI-related initiatives.

Moving on to ASI

Although we are still working on artificial general intelligence, there is no harm in thinking about the next step: artificial super intelligence (ASI). But why go for ASI; what can we expect from it?

Obviously, artificial super intelligence would be way ahead of general intelligence. According to Microsoft’s Copilot, “Artificial Super Intelligence (ASI) is a hypothetical form of AI that surpasses human intelligence in all aspects, including creativity, problem-solving, and emotional understanding. Unlike current AI systems, which are limited to specific tasks (artificial narrow intelligence or ANI), ASI would possess general intelligence and the ability to learn and adapt across various domains.”

So, ASI is expected to surpass human intelligence in all aspects, including emotional understanding. Wow! Your close relation may not understand your emotions and feelings, but ASI would.

Some of the benefits of ASI that we can think of at present include making the best decisions for healthcare, finance, and research, developing life-saving drugs and improving treatments; space exploration and the creation of new materials and energy sources; and